

Sahar Darafsh

Software Engineer

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Skills

Frameworks and Libraries:

- PyTorch
- TensorFlow
- OpenCV
- Spring Framework
- Flutter

Tools and Platforms:

- Git
- Maven
- Jenkins
- SonarQube
- JUnit

Programming Languages:

- Java
- Python
- Dart

Database Management:

- MySQL
- Flyway
- Liquibase

Development Methodologies:

- Agile Methodologies
- CI/CD
- TDD

Cloud & Infrastructure:

- Amazon Web Services
- Docker

Work Experience

Full Stack Developer

March 2025 - Present

Convien GmbH, Munich, Germany [convien.com]

- Build and maintain full-stack features for a large-scale meeting-place optimizer using Java and Apache Wicket, ensuring high availability and sub-second response times.
- Lead proactive code-quality initiatives to address code smells, vulnerabilities, and technical debt, materially improving maintainability, security, and long-term reliability.
- Own quality management and validation pipelines, establishing robust testing processes that raise software reliability and keep the product compliant with project standards.

Software Developer

March 2022 - March 2025

TESTIFI GmbH, Munich, Germany [testifi.io]

- Designed and shipped an Android app in Flutter, then pivoted to backend Java development to build QualityOps, a comprehensive tool for evaluating and visualizing software quality metrics.
- Engineered core QualityOps features with TDD, using optimized algorithms aligned with stakeholder requirements, boosting tool performance.
- Known for fast, high-quality bug fixes that minimized downtime and significantly improved software stability.
- Contributed to CAST, a cross-team test automation initiative, increasing testing efficiency and coverage accuracy.

Deep Learning Mentor and Teaching Assistant (Part-Time)

June 2021 - March 2023

Maktabkhooneh, Tehran, Iran [maktabkhooneh.org]

- Taught and mentored 100+ students across Reinforcement Learning, CNNs, Neural Networks, and Deep Learning, consistently receiving high engagement scores.
- Co-developed curriculum by integrating real-world industry applications, bridging theory and practice to improve student outcomes.

AI/ML Project Reviewer

June 2020 - March 2022

Abadan University of Medical Science, Abadan, Iran [abadanums.ac.ir]

- Reviewed deep learning projects in medical image analysis, verifying model architecture choices, training procedures, and evaluation metrics.
- Provided targeted algorithmic feedback that improved model accuracy.

Education

MSc. Artificial Intelligence and Robotics

Sep. 2017 - June 2020

Amirkabir University of Technology, Tehran, Iran

Thesis Title: Designing an Embedded System for Activity Recognition using a Surveillance Camera

BSc. Computer Engineering

Sep. 2011 - Sep. 2016

Isfahan University of Technology, Isfahan, Iran

Internship: Developed an Android application using Java to retrieve IT Center web page information using JSON and HTML parsers

Final Project: Developed an Android application enabling navigation and location sharing among users.

Certificates

Design Patterns - by the University of Alberta

Nov. 2024

Object-Oriented Design - by the University of Alberta

Nov. 2024

Agile with Atlassian Jira - by Atlassian University

Nov. 2022

Version Control with Git - by Atlassian University

Nov. 2022

AI for Medicine Specialization - by DeepLearning.AI

Aug. 2021

Deep Learning Specialization - by DeepLearning.AI

June 2021

Reinforcement Learning Specialization - by the University of Alberta

May 2021

Generative Adversarial Networks (GAN) Specialization - by DeepLearning.AI

May 2021

Awards and Recognition

- Awarded **Employee of the Month** at TESTIFI GmbH (March 2024) for exceptional bug-resolution speed and code quality.

Languages

- Persian (Native)
- English (Fluent)
- German (B1, in Progress)

Hobbies

- Exploring new recipes
- Getting lost in new cities (on purpose)
- Building the apps and AI tools I wished existed

About Me

I'd like to achieve the most with the least, and I have an example!

For my master's thesis, I built a system that recognized human intentions from video. There was no public dataset, so I created my own. The hardware could barely keep up with the training, so I made every decision count. Instead of treating these limits as obstacles, I treated them as the specification. It worked, and it taught me more than any comfortable project would have.

That experience shaped how I work today. When something is missing, I make it. When resources are thin, I think harder instead of waiting for more. And I like understanding a problem well enough to explain it simply, because that is the only real test of understanding.

What draws me now is making models work in the real world, not just in experiments. Getting something to work is one thing. Keeping it working is another, and I want both.

I am still learning, deliberately and constantly. That is the point.